

What is a Child and Youth Advocate?



In Canada, a Child and Youth Advocate is an **independent** and **appointed** representative in a province or territory who holds **explicit legislated mandates** to protect the rights of children and youth through **individual & systemic advocacy.**

What is a Child and Youth Advocate?

Define: Independent



Define:



Independent

A Child and Youth Advocate operates separately from the government to ensure the Advocate has freedom to speak and act without influence from political decisions or pressures. This independence allows them to represent the interests of children and youth impartially and effectively.



Independent

Currently, there is **no independent office** for the Child and Youth Advocate in the NWT.



Independent

An example of an existing **independent** office in the NWT is the Office of the Ombud, which addresses and seeks to resolve concerns about administrative unfairness within territorial public authorities.

The NWT Ombud operates under the **Ombud Act**, legislation that was enacted by the NWT Legislative Assembly in 2018. Following the passage of the Ombud Act, the Office of the Ombud was established.

What is a Child and Youth Advocate?

Define: Appointed



Define:



Appointed

The Advocate is selected through a formal process, typically by the territorial government, to ensure accountability and transparency in fulfilling their responsibilities.



Appointed

In the NWT, the Ombud is appointed by the Commissioner of the NWT. In July 2024, Krista Carnogursky was appointed to a 5-year term as the Ombud.

How does the process work? First, the 'Board of Management', which consists of a few Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLAs), recruits a candidate for the Ombud role. They recommend to the Legislative Assembly (all MLAs) to make a motion to recommend this candidate to the Commissioner. Once this happens, the Commissioner can appoint the Ombud.

advocate-nwt.ca

References: <https://www.ntlegislativeassembly.ca/hansard/hn240523>
<https://www.mytruenorthnow.com/69984/featured/krista-carnogursky-appointed-ombud-of-the-northwest-territories/>
<https://www.ntlegislativeassembly.ca/committees/board-management>
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What is a Child and Youth Advocate?

Define: Legislated Mandates



Define:



Legislated Mandates

Legislated mandates are rules set by law that organizations or government offices must follow.

For example, Child and Youth Advocate offices in Canada have mandates outlined in legislation. The legislation itself is usually called a 'Child and Youth Advocacy Act' which is a detailed written document. This document tells the Child and Youth Advocate office what they must do to protect and support young people.



Legislated Mandates

A specific example is the Child and Youth Advocate Act in Alberta. This law requires the Office of the Child and Youth Advocate (OCYA) to speak up for children and youth receiving government services, such as those in foster care. The office must ensure young people's voices are heard in decisions that affect them and report on issues impacting their well-being.